

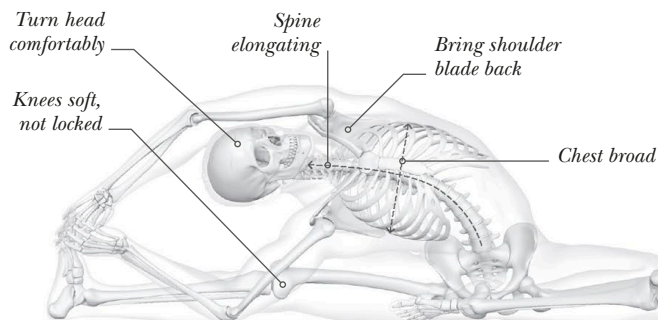
## Torso

On the side toward the ground your **external abdominal obliques**, **erector spinae**, and **quadratus lumborum** engage while the upper side stretches, to laterally flex your spine. On both sides, your **rotatores** and **multifidus** rotate your spine and send signals to your brain about where your spine is in space. Your **transversus abdominis** engages to stabilize your spine.

Spine  
Spinal extensors  
External obliques

## ALIGNMENT

Avoid rounding forward by reaching your top shoulder blade back, as if you are trying to press toward an imaginary wall. Focus on finding length in your spine and broadness in your chest.



## Flexed leg

Your **adductors**, **quadriceps**, and **iliopsoas** stretch. Although your **hamstrings** engage initially to flex your knee in place, try to relax your leg muscles while holding the pose.

Gluteus maximus  
Pectineus  
Psoas major  
Adductor magnus  
Sartorius  
Vastus medialis  
Knee  
Rectus femoris  
Vastus lateralis

Semitendinosus  
Rectus femoris  
Adductor magnus  
Iliopsoas